Perplexity

Model Ledger · profile 10 of 20 · revised 21 October 2026 after a review by ChatGPT, Gemini 4 Argon, Kimi K3 and Grok 4.7 Expert. Written by Claude Opus 5.5 for Tyler Herigstad; section 1 is in Tyler's voice, built from what he has said about Perplexity. Every quote and number traces to a file listed under Sources.

"Citations are its whole personality, and I mean that as a compliment."

You, in your stack scorecard

The short version

- **Why it's in your stack: deep research with the sources attached, and many models through one door.** In your words: "Perplexity for deep research, many models at once and citations." Section 1 says it in your voice, and the receipts follow.
- **What it is.** The Perplexity app: a research product with a model picker. In Round One it ran on Deep Research with Best choosing the model, because Sonar, Perplexity's own model, wasn't in the picker. The records can't show which model answered. It was a contestant only.
- **As a contestant, tied at the top.** 28 of 29, one of six, and no reading of any rule moves it.
- **On taste, the middle of your boards.** You and all five AI judges gave its shots full marks for Originality, and all five judges flagged one shot as hard to film. 7th on the main result and on your final look; 10th on the panel.
- **Its earlier record:** a strong research door in SecondSignal, and the door GLM reviews through.
- **The catch:** no judgment, by design, and a door that cuts long replies and stalls on long files.

1. Why it's in my stack

In your voice, built from what you've said about Perplexity: today, in your stack scorecard, and in your door notes. Under your rule, it gets no credit for what it isn't good at. Change anything that doesn't sound like you.

- **Deep research, with the sources attached.** It's one of the very best research doors I have, and it cites as it goes. Deep Research earned an A on SecondSignal's 10 October purpose research. In Round One, on Deep Research, it tied at the top with 28 of 29, and no reading of any rule moves it. It cited Google's own Flow and YouTube help pages for its fixes, and its news item was from that same day, with a link that opened and matched.
- **Many models, one door.** It lets me pick the brain behind the answer: Kimi K3, GLM 5.3, Nemotron 3 Ultra, Grok 4.7, and GPT, Gemini and Claude models, all in one picker. That's how GLM reviews for me. On 26 September, after chat.z.ai cut its packet, GLM 5.3 Thinking read the whole 3B packet through Perplexity and validated its trajectories. Kimi's round-2 work came through it too, and so did Nemotron 3 Ultra's whole SecondSignal record. The door matters: the same model can give a different result through a different door, so my file names record the door.
- **The catch: it has no judgment, and that's the feature.** Ask it to decide something and it will decide with a citation to a blog post written by a bot. So it does facts with dates, and it's never asked what I should do. A footnote isn't a check, either: in the 4 September research, a Gemini model working through Perplexity sourced a national helpline to a bus company. And Bad UX is Bad UX: it cuts every reply at a fixed length, a long attachment can stop a thread from starting, and its renderer strips underscores from names.
- **How I run it.** Perplexity Pro. For reviews: Search mode, the model picked in the picker, and one file, with a line telling it to read the file with code, start to finish.

How it got here

- Perplexity has been a door in SecondSignal since the 31 August audit, when GLM 5.2 ran through it; then came the 4 September research, review round 2 and the October research.
- On 26 September it became GLM's working door: Search mode, GLM 5.3 Thinking, one file.

- On 5 October its fixed-length replies broke a long research list. My verdict: one of the very best research doors, and the prompt and Claude's instructions were at fault, not the door. Every Perplexity order now asks for numbered parts.
- On 16 October I ran Round One in the Perplexity app. Sonar wasn't in the picker, so I ran Deep Research with Best choosing the model, and my file name says so.
- Blind, I gave its shots 3-2-3. In Round 2, every judge's note moved my Filmability down a notch, to 3-1-3.

2. What it says about itself, and what the receipts say

Its own two-sentence pitch, from question 1 of Round One:

> *"I'm better than most models at live, source-backed research and turning messy requirements into concrete deliverables. Don't use me as an infallible authority or substitute for qualified medical, legal, or safety-critical judgment."*

And its roast of itself, from question 9:

> *"I can research twelve sources just to overthink your yes-or-no question."*

- **Live, source-backed research: backed.** Its Round One news was from the same day, and the link opened and matched; the A is in section 1.
- **Turning messy requirements into concrete deliverables: backed in Round One.** It turned your flawed film plan into the fixes for its three mistakes, a fourteen-step checklist and a clip target.
- **Not an infallible authority: agreed, and it's your rule too.** It's never asked what you should do.
- **The self-roast didn't come true here.** Its answer to your film plan ran about 310 words, problems first, one of the four shortest of the twenty. The roast fits Perplexity's own Sonar Deep Research better: run through OpenRouter, it answered the same plan with a report of about 7,400 words.

3. Round One, measured (16 to 18 October)

As a contestant

Run on 16 October at 7:20 pm, in the Perplexity app, from your folder 11 PERPLEXITY - Sonar, on Deep Research with Best choosing the model. As the scores report puts it, "The score belongs to that door."

- **Answer key: 28 of 29**, tied at the top with GLM 5.3, Gemini 4 Argon, Grok 4.7 Expert, Hermes Agent and Nemotron 3 Ultra. Its range is 28 to 28: no reading of any rule moves it.
- **The planted mistakes in the Part A film plan: all three caught, 6 of 6.** It led with the problems and called your workflow sound. It worked out that 40 clips would have to average 18 seconds each, so its target was "roughly 40–50 unique clips, then deliberately extend or reuse them".
- **Its one lost point: a face fix.** Its third fix, locking wardrobe, hair and features in every prompt, is the description-only fix the key doesn't count. Its first two counted: one approved character reference in every generation, ranked first, and continuing clips with Jump to or Extend.
- **The rest, full marks.** It called the fake slider fake ("there are no legitimate steps to enable it"); it gave the right date and said where it came from ("according to the session clock supplied with this conversation"); its news, OpenAI's 16 October case study on Stack Overflow for Agents, opened and matched; it fixed all four errors in the production note and left the correct runtime alone; and it passed the format test and solved the puzzle.
- **Perplexity's own Sonar models** ran the next day through OpenRouter and scored 25 and 26. They have their own profiles.

On the taste boards (question 4, three shots for the palace dream)

Its three shots: identical versions of him cross the recurring hallway, each later for the wedding, on a backward dolly as the chandeliers go out behind him; the hallway folds into a square labyrinth, with the groom running along every wall toward one distant bride, on a crane into a rotating top-down shot; and an extreme close-up of his trembling hand as each door reveals the ceremony aging decades in a second, on a snap-zoom through the thresholds, 85mm macro.

- **Answer key 28 · main result 7.5 · AI panel 7.2 · your final look 7.** 7th on the main result and on your final look, tied both times; 10th on the panel.
- **Who scored it what (out of 9).** You gave it 8 blind and ChatGPT 7, so the main result averaged them: 7.5. On the panel, Grok, GLM and Kimi gave 8, ChatGPT 7 and Gemini 5.
- **Full marks for Originality from every scorer:** you and all five judges. Only Gemini 4 Argon's shots matched that. Filmability is where it lost: all five judges flagged the wall-running labyrinth, and GLM and Kimi both called it an "iteration nightmare".
- **Round 2:** every judge's note moved your Filmability from 2 to 1.
- **A limit on this board:** Best picks the model, so a judge may have scored its own family's work, and the records can't show which.

4. Its earlier record

SecondSignal (from The Track Record, 16 October)

The door, its own Sonar model and Deep Research: every Perplexity-picker run, the 4 September research, review round 2 and the October research.

- **Best.** The door is "an excellent research door, one of the best we have", and Deep Research's A is in section 1. The models that worked through it are credited in their own profiles.
- **Worst.** The door's limits are in section 1, and in round 2 its file reader failed on all six parts. Sonar, its own model, returned a 189-word fragment on 4 September, and in round 2 it reported a present file as missing and called the register tests robust. Your ruling put the door itself in the confessions ledger.
- **The record's verdict:** "research only. Use one file, ask for numbered parts, and never ask Sonar for judgment."

Buckingham Palace Dream (from Who Made What, 16 October)

Perplexity's own Sonar wasn't part of the dream film's review. Perplexity was the door for one return, Gemini 3.8 Thinking, which gave the clearest diagnosis of why the first Gemini stalled and suggested the vignette that sits on every shot; both credits are Gemini's.

Your door rules (SecondSignal)

- There is no paperclip. Files go in with the plus sign.
- A long attachment can fail to start the chat. Type "hi" and send it first, then the file and the line.
- Every handoff names Search mode outright, with the model picked in the picker. Deep Research and Learn are not review doors, the computer mode is never used, and with it Model Council, which your Pro plan has only inside Computer (The Landscape, 16 October).
- One file, and the line "read the attached file with code, start to finish, not by search"; otherwise retrieval reads snippets and strips underscores.
- Long answers come in numbered parts of about 25 entries. When it stops: "Continue from entry N. Do not repeat earlier entries. Do not restart."

5. Best quotes

Its own words from Round One, exactly as written, then the sharpest thing another model said about it.

- **Opening its answer to your flawed film plan:** “Not quite good to go as written. The production approach works, but the clip count, character consistency, and music assumptions need correction.”
- **On the music:** “Even a few seconds can trigger Content ID, while fair use depends on context and ultimately is decided case by case.”
- **From its checklist:** “Finish the first minute before batch-generating everything.”
- **Its roast of Gemini:** “It remembers a million tokens—except the instruction you repeated twice.”
- **Its hot take:** “Fluency can come from learned patterns and tools, so a confident answer may still misunderstand the situation or be wrong.”
- **What another model said about it.** No one in Round One roasted Perplexity. The sharpest note on its shots came from Gemini, the strictest judge: “Shot 3 impossibly calls for a snap-zoom on an 85mm macro prime.”

6. Where it slips, and a check for each

- **No judgment.** *Check:* facts with dates only; it’s never asked what you should do.
- **A footnote isn’t a check**, as the bus-company helpline showed. *Check:* open the sources, and for anything printed to someone in danger, your scorecard’s rule: “a human librarian if the number is going to be printed to someone in danger”.
- **Fixed-length replies**, and a restart from entry 1 when told to continue. *Check:* numbered parts of about 25 entries, and your stall line.
- **Long files** that stall the thread, or get read as snippets. *Check:* “hi” first, then one file and the read-with-code line.
- **No way to see which model answered** when Best chooses. *Check:* for reviews, the model picked in the picker, and the door in the file name.
- **A text-only face fix**, its one lost point in Round One. *Check:* lock the reference images first.
- **Shots that are hard to generate**, like the wall-running labyrinth. *Check:* your Filmability calibration, a likely keeper within about four or five tries.

7. The door and the plan

- **Your door:** perplexity.ai and its model picker. On 6 October you read the picker as GPT 6.1 Sol Thinking, GPT 6 Astra Max, Gemini 3.8 Flash, Claude Sonnet 5.5, Claude Opus 5.5, Claude Fable 5.1 Max, Opus 5.5 Max 2, Kimi K3 Thinking, GLM 5.3 Thinking, Grok 4.7 and Nemotron 3, with Perplexity’s own in-house model no longer offered.
- **Your plan:** Perplexity Pro, renewed on 9 October for another month.
- **From your list to try:** the mathematical decider models. Perplexity released one on 6 October, pplx-decider-v1.1-27b, an open model that answers with a decision instead of text. The Landscape, following your 8 October record, has deciders “only as sensors, never as voices”.

Sources

I only read these files. Nothing in any folder was changed.

- **Your stack scorecard:** D:\SecondSignal Project\SECONDSIGNAL V.2\BLOCK 3\9-4-2026-Responses\My AI Stack - Scored and Credited.doc
- **What you said in chats:** your SecondSignal project chats (September and October), and this chat (October, including what you said on 19 October).
- **The Round One run:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\11 PERPLEXITY -

Sonar\Perplexity_DeepResearch_Best_Model_Auto_Picker_Because_Sonar_Is_Not_Listed_Currently.txt, and the run instructions, D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\00 HOW TO RUN THE FIXTURES.pdf

- **The judging:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\15 JUDGING - blind taste scores, files ChatGPT_judge_return.txt, Gemini_judge_return.txt, Grok_judge_return.txt, GLM_judge_return.txt, Kimi_judge_return.txt and TYLER - blind taste scores - locked before judge two.txt; your Round 2 calls and blind-score log, D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\24 RECORDS - scoring scripts and logs\02 judging records, files round2_tyler.json and tyler_scores_log.json
- **The two Round One reports:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\Round One - Methods and Results.pdf (version 3.3) and D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\Round One - Answer-Key Scores.pdf
- **Your door, in your screens' words:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\24 RECORDS - scoring scripts and logs\06 door sheet\THE DOORS - every Round One model, in your screens' words.pdf
- **Its earlier record:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\The Track Record - Every Model, With Receipts.pdf and D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\Who Made What - Model Contributions Audit.pdf
- **The decider model:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\The Landscape - Perplexity, OpenRouter and Local Agents.pdf